GANDHI by Jane Rollason
(A2–A2+)

INTRODUCTION

Ss read an extract from *Gandhi* by Jane Rollason about the Salt March in 1930. Then they create a timeline of Gandhi's life and compare his life and work with Nelson Mandela's.

Supplementary Materials

CLIL CONNECTION: internet access OR the **Pearson English eReader** of *Gandhi*.

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION: you may need internet access BUT it is recommended to do this Literature Lesson after the unit in the Students' Book about Nelson Mandela so this activity can be done by looking back at past work instead of doing all new research. Access to the **Pearson English eReader** of *Gandhi*.

WARM UP

Show the picture along the bottom of the pages and ask *Who are these people? What ages? How do they feel? Where are they going?* Ss can be as creative as they like with their answers so don't confirm at this stage. Later in the lesson, after Ss have done the reading, tell them the monument is a memorial to the Salt March. It's called the Gyarah Murti Monument and it's in New Delhi, India. It shows Gandhi in the lead, with ten followers.

Culture notes

Gandhi
Mahatma Gandhi is one of the most important and popular leaders in the history of the modern world. He fought for equality in South Africa and India. But he lived a quiet, simple life, and was totally opposed to violence. His work led to independence for India, and his nonviolent methods have been used by many great leaders since.

Colonial India
India was the most important country in the British Empire, but British colonies also stretched across Asia, Australasia, Africa, the Caribbean and Canada. By 1905, more than 345 million people across the world were ruled by Britain. Britain used its colonies to get cheap labour, cheap resources, and as a market for British goods. Although the British claimed that they were exporting positive values (including Christianity) the truth was more dreadful: they killed thousands of innocent indigenous people around the world in order to gain power in these lands.

The Salt March
Salt was taxed by the British government in India. But Gandhi organised a march to the ocean to take salt without paying. Thousands of Indians followed his example. Britain at last understood the scale and importance of Indian resistance to British rule and agreed to talk. Gandhi went to London to talk to the country's leaders, but didn't win independence for his country. That came after the Second World War, in 1947, but there still wasn't peace as the country was split into two, Muslim and Hindu, with violent conflict. Gandhi's message of peace and understanding between the two religions became less and less popular. This feeling lead to Gandhi's assassination in 1948 by Nathuram Godse, a Hindu.

PREPARATION

THINKING ROUTINE

1

see

Focus Ss on the picture of Gandhi. Ask *Who is this? What does he look like?*

ANSWERS:

1 Mahatma Gandhi
2 An older man, in his 60s maybe, wearing glasses. He has no hair. He's Indian. He's smiling and looks friendly. He's thin.

think, wonder

Focus Ss on the questions and allow time for them to discuss in pairs. For Question 6, they should write down their three questions to come back to later.

ANSWERS:

Ss' own answers

READING PREVIEW

Focus Ss on the title and ask *Where do you get salt?* (a shop, the sea). Encourage them to think beyond the supermarket but where they could get salt if there was none in the shops. Ask *Can you just take salt from the sea?* (yes, of course!) *Imagine if someone from another country made you pay to take salt from the sea. Is that right?* Encourage discussion but it will probably be a confusing idea for them, like being made to pay to breathe. Tell them this is what the British did to Indian people when they ruled India.

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READING EXTRACT LL2.01

Tell Ss they are going to read an extract from *Gandhi* about a time when he fought for the rights of Indian people against the British. Allow time for them to read in silence, or play the recording while they read. If you're going to play the recording, focus on the glossary words in the box first so Ss will understand them when they listen and read.

When they have finished, ask *Was Gandhi right?* Ask *What were the surprising things in the story?* (Gandhi's age when he did such a long walk; that salt was taxed; that people went to prison just for taking salt; that so many people went to prison; that Gandhi didn't mind being in prison; perhaps also that all this was done peacefully by the people who went on the march.)

COMPREHENSION

2 **Books closed. Write the Question stem from question 1 on the board. See if Ss can remember the answer. Do not confirm at this stage. Then with books open, Ss read Question 1 and the options. Ask if any of the options match their initial answer. Tell them instincts can be correct but they must look for evidence in the text. Elicit the correct answer (c) and the place in the text that supports that conclusion (lines 1–2 say he wanted the British to leave).**

Allow Ss time to read and answer the rest of the questions. Get feedback as a class and check the answers. Ask Ss to supply the line from the text that supported their ideas, even if they offer the wrong answer as it helps them see where they went wrong.

ANSWERS:

1 c **2** a **3** d **4** c **5** a

Teaching tip

With multiple-choice questions, encourage Ss to make good guesses when they're working out the answer. If one or two of the options are obviously wrong, they can cross them off and then they have a 50/50 chance of being right if there are two options left. If they can support their choice with the text, they have a very good chance of getting the answer right.

CLIL CONNECTION

History

3 **1** **Draw a timeline on the board and mark and label the dates from the extract on it (1930, the Salt March and 1931, Gandhi goes to Britain). Tell Ss they are going to build a timeline of important events in Gandhi's life. Allow time for them to research, either online or using the Pearson English eReader to build a timeline.**

They can work with a partner to give opportunity for speaking and collaboration. Instead of feedback, ask Ss to compare their timelines with another pair and use the Pearson English eReader as reference for any disagreement on information.

ANSWERS:

Many possibilities, but could include 1869 – his birth; 1888 – he went to London to study law; 1893 – he left India for South Africa 1893 – he was asked to leave the train for being Indian; 1904 – started his first ashram; 1907 – his first non-violent protest; 1913 – organised

a huge protest march for Indian rights in South Africa and went to prison; 1915 – he returned to India; 1919 – organised a 'no work day' protest; 1922 – went to prison for two years for organising protests against the British; 1924 – fasted to protest Muslim-Hindu violence; 1930 – started the Salt March; 1931 – went to London to talk with the British about independence; 1933 – turned his attention to

the poor in India; 1944 – his wife died; 1946 – worked to help make peace with Muslim Indians after losing the struggle for a united India; 1947 – sees India become independent; January 30, 1948 – died.

2 **Refer Ss to the questions they wrote for Ex 1 Question 6 and ask if they have answered any of their questions.**

ACTIVE INVESTIGATION

4 **Brainstorm onto the board anything Ss remember from learning about Nelson Mandela previously in the Student's Book. In pairs, they should think of all the similarities and differences between the two men. It will help if they have absorbed a lot of the Pearson English eReader while planning the timetable. You may like to set homework to read the book before doing this activity. If you wish, you can give hints for things to think about: their job/profession; who they were fighting against; beliefs; methods; deaths; prizes; attitudes towards violence. In feedback, elicit Ss' ideas as a class**

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ANSWERS:

Similarities: practised law; connected with South Africa; imprisoned; fought British rule; fought racism; believed in freedom and equality; used non-violent protest; encouraged different groups to work together for common goals.

Differences: Mandela didn't see the point of hunger strikes while Gandhi used them effectively; Mandela died naturally, Gandhi was assassinated; Gandhi worked for equality outside his home country as well as at home in India; Mandela saw a place for violent protest but Gandhi was committed to only non-violence; Mandela won a Nobel Peace Prize but Gandhi did not.

SPEAKING

5 Remind Ss that Gandhi's protests were peaceful. Ask *What other ways are there to protest peacefully?* Elicit a list onto the board and guide Ss to answers from the Answer Key if they run out of ideas. Ask *Have you ever protested something in any of these ways?* They can share experiences with a partner.

Give Ss a few minutes to read the question and think about their answer. Divide Ss into pairs and they should tell their partner what they would like to protest and why, and see if their partner agrees that it's something that needs to change. Monitor and help with vocabulary as needed.

ANSWERS:

Many possible answers including: marches and demonstrations; hunger strikes; signing petitions; sit ins, banging pots and pans like in Spain; letters writing campaigns like Amnesty International; labour strikes; not paying taxes; boycotts, e.g. not buying things from certain countries or companies.

Homework ideas

- Ss write about something unjust that they would like to protest and why and how, using the ideas they came up with in Speakout.
- Ss write a news article about the Salt March. They can choose to write it as if in a British or Indian paper at the time and think about how the two papers might view the events and tell them in a different way. This might need some planning in class first.

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